

Facebook Community & Membership Strategy

What the visible Facebook audience responds to, what it expects, and how to invite it into a living sangha without pressure.

Prepared from Michael Gregory's visible Facebook profile, selected post comments, client documents, and project context. Public comments are research candidates only and require explicit permission before publication as testimonials.

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Executive summary

Michael Gregory's Facebook profile is a warm, teaching-led community channel with approximately 21,000 visible followers. It performs best when it gives a complete thought, a lineage milestone, or a clear invitation to live teaching. The audience responds through gratitude, devotional language, sharing, registration, donations, and practical questions about time zones and recordings.

The membership should not be sold to this audience as a bundle of content. It should be presented as a dependable rhythm of live teaching, practice, friendship, and personal orientation within a path taught in order. That proposition fits both the visible behaviour on Facebook and Lama Michael's stated wish for an engaged community rather than volume.

The most important commercial insight is also the simplest: the Facebook audience already trusts the teaching. Its friction is practical and relational - not persuasive. People need to know what happens, when it happens, whether recordings exist, where they should begin, and whether membership will help them practise consistently rather than merely give them more material.

Primary recommendation

Use Facebook to teach and orient; use the website to clarify the path; use email to build a steady relationship; use one live course as the first paid experience; invite membership after trust and participation already exist.

Immediate priorities

- Obtain three permissioned, first-person student testimonials that name the course, retreat, or length of practice.
- Create a single canonical weekly schedule with real times, time-zone support, and an explicit recording policy.
- Frame membership as belonging and practice rhythm, not unlimited access.
- Build a short welcome sequence from free course to live teaching to membership.
- Confirm which Facebook property corresponds to the previously reported audience of roughly 600,000; do not publish that figure until verified.

Evidence, scope and limitations

This report uses information visible on Michael Gregory's Facebook profile while signed in, selected expanded comment threads, the legacy and reworked Vajragarbha websites, client meeting notes, and project email context.

It is not a Facebook Insights export. The report cannot determine reach, impressions, follower growth, video completion, link clicks, conversions, demographic composition, paid-versus-organic distribution, or unique commenters. Visible counts are snapshots and can change.

Testimonial standard

A public comment is not automatically permission to republish it in advertising or on a website. Every quotation in this report is a candidate. Before use, obtain affirmative permission, confirm the person's direct relationship with Vajragarbha, agree any edit, and record how their name should appear.

Quality test for publication

- The person actually attended, studied, practised, or belonged - not merely registered or praised a post.
- The quote describes a specific experience without implying guaranteed outcomes.
- The wording remains recognisably theirs after editing.
- The attribution and years of practice are confirmed.
- Written permission is stored.

What students say · candidate library

The comments below are ranked by usefulness. Only the first two contain evidence of participation or return. The remaining comments are useful social proof but should not be presented as student outcomes without follow-up.

Tier 1 · strongest candidates

“Thank you for making these teachings accessible to us all... Looking forward to being back in class.”

Doug Dodd · Returning student · Dzogchen Practices and Transmission
Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid0mJ... · comment 1245735182865440

Why it matters: this is the clearest evidence of a prior class experience, perceived accessibility, and intention to return. With permission, shorten only after Doug approves the final wording.

“Thank you for this wonderful opportunity, Lama la. I have signed up and donated. I don’t think I can make the live transmission because of the time difference, so bless you for making recordings available.”

Matthew Vagg · Registered participant · international/time-zone access
Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid0mJ... · comment 677659953293980

Why it matters: it proves that recordings are an access requirement for an international audience. It is an enrolment endorsement, not yet an outcome testimonial.

Tier 2 · enrolment and trust

“Thank you for this beautiful gift. I am signed up.”

Danae Dorji · Registered participant
Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid0mJ... · comment 751682032497566

“I have joined and look forward to this wonderful opportunity.”

Alex Weith · Registered participant
Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid0mJ... · comment 1381405822286689

Tier 3 · community, retreat and lineage endorsements

“I lack the words to express my gratitude and awe at this great accomplishment - the heart drop of the guru in the pond of sangha, ripples flowing through timelessly and touching the awakened hearts of all beings.”

Sangye Gyatso · Three-year retreat completion

Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid023... · comment 1368657193835628

“A very beautiful moment - thank you for sharing this so we can all rejoice, Lama Michael. This can be, and should be, acknowledged as a very important moment for the Dharma in the West.”

Andrew MacMillan · Three-year retreat completion

Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid023... · comment 401987175761781

“This is the best news of the day - thank you for the service to humanity, Michael Gregory La.”

Ani Yudrön · Three-year retreat completion

Source: facebook.com/.../posts/pfbid023... · comment 911587737174252

Editorial conclusion

The current public comments demonstrate reverence, warmth, international participation, and trust. They do not yet provide three strong first-person accounts of what it is like to study with Lama Michael. The website should not pretend otherwise. Use this list to request short follow-up reflections from known students.

Visible Facebook statistics

Measure	Visible figure	Interpretation
Followers	Approx. 21,000	Meaningful warm audience on Michael's profile
Following	912	Personal-profile behaviour, not a broadcast-only page
Recent sample	3 teaching posts	Directional, not a full performance audit
Average reactions	224	Teaching content attracts steady acknowledgement
Average comments	26	A small but active conversational layer
Average shares	22	Teachings travel beyond the immediate follower base

Recent sample

Post theme	Reactions	Comments	Shares
Dissatisfaction and its source	135	15	15
Awareness, luminosity and ignorance	301	29	26
Reflect Deeply	235	33	26

Other visible signals

- Dalai Lama quotation: 568 reactions, 29 comments, approximately 1,100 shares.
- Three-year retreat completion: 345 reactions, 72 comments, 10 shares.
- Pemako Thanksgiving: 279 reactions, 60 comments, 7 shares.
- Dzogchen Practices and Transmission: 117 reactions, 33 comments, 24 shares.
- Historical Bodhisattva teaching shared from Mindfulness Meditation Centers: 822 reactions, 13 comments, 14 shares.

The reported figure of roughly 600,000 followers in meeting notes does not match the 21,000 visible on this profile. It may refer to another property or combined historical reach. Confirm before using it publicly.

How Facebook is currently used

Teaching and contemplation

Short teachings, quotations, practice reflections and images. This is the most consistent content and the clearest source of shares.

Course and transmission announcements

Live schedules, registration, donation, hybrid attendance and recordings. Comments frequently become operational support.

Retreat and lineage milestones

Three-year retreat completion and Pemako community moments produce strong gratitude and institutional proof.

Human presence

Travel, nature, celebrations and life with Davita make the teacher feel human and approachable.

Cross-property routing

The profile links to Dzogchen Teaching, Quiet Mind/Pemako, Mindfulness Meditation Centers, Instagram and related sites.

Observed weakness

The channel mixes personal profile, teacher platform, organisation page, course-support desk and retreat-centre story. That warmth is valuable, but the next step is often unclear. Facebook should not carry the full burden of explaining eligibility, schedules, pricing, recordings or the order of the path.

What this community appears to expect

Substance before promotion

People respond to complete teachings and meaningful reflections. Pure sales posts would feel out of place.

Access across geography

Time zones and recordings appear repeatedly. Global participation needs to be designed, not treated as an exception.

A real teacher and lineage

Respect clusters around Lama Michael, transmission, serious training and the completion of retreat.

Clarity about the next step

Questions about start times, recordings and registration show that practical uncertainty is a major source of friction.

Warmth without pressure

The language of gratitude, blessing and gift suggests an audience sensitive to overt commercialisation.

Belonging and continuity

Returning-to-class language and rejoicing in sangha milestones point to an appetite for sustained relationship.

Integrity and permission

Advanced practitioners expect prerequisites, transmission and teaching context to be handled carefully.

How to position the membership

The membership is not a content subscription. Facebook already supplies abundant teachings for free, and Teachable already contains a large archive. Selling 'more content' would intensify the very overwhelm the website rework is trying to remove.

Recommended positioning

A living rhythm of practice, teaching and spiritual friendship - with a clear next step in a path taught in order.

The membership promise

- You do not have to construct the path alone.
- There is a dependable weekly rhythm that makes practice easier to sustain.
- Live teaching and sangha turn study into relationship rather than consumption.
- If you miss a live session, recordings preserve access across time zones.
- You can begin at the right level; advanced teachings retain their real prerequisites.
- Fees support the infrastructure that keeps teachings, people and place available.

What not to promise

- Transformation, healing, awakening or attainment on a timetable.
- Unlimited access as the central value proposition.
- Personal access to Lama Michael unless the exact form and capacity are confirmed.
- Scarcity or urgency beyond a true course start date or capacity limit.
- That payment constitutes transmission, empowerment or progress.

Membership message architecture

Layer	Question answered	Recommended message
Orientation	What is this?	A living sangha for people practising a complete Buddhist path in order.
Relevance	Why join?	A weekly rhythm helps teaching become practice and practice become relationship.
Proof	Why trust it?	Live guidance, named lineage, long practice, completed retreats and a real community.
Specifics	What happens?	Show the entire week: class names, exact times, time zones, recordings and prerequisites.
Access	Can I participate?	State beginner entry, recordings, cancellation, dāna or scholarship information plainly.
Invitation	What next?	Join the Sangha - or begin with the complete free course if you are not ready.

Suggested headline and supporting copy

A living rhythm for the path.

Practise with Lama Michael and a community of students through live teachings, guided meditation and spiritual friendship. Follow the path at the level that is right for you, with recordings when you cannot attend live.

Who should receive the membership invitation

New Facebook follower	Context and confidence	Free course or one live introductory class
Free-course participant	A way to continue	Invite to a live class, then membership
Past course buyer	Continuity and practice	Show the weekly sangha rhythm
Returning student	What is happening now	Schedule plus membership invitation
Advanced practitioner	Precision and prerequisites	Relevant advanced teaching page; membership second
Retreat participant	Integration and relationship	Post-retreat sequence into regular sangha practice

Core rule

Do not show every visitor the same ask. The membership is appropriate after someone understands the teacher, the path and the weekly rhythm. The free course remains a complete and dignified destination for everyone else.

Channel roles and conversion path

Channel	Job	Primary action
Facebook	Teach, reach and reveal the living community	Read/watch, then visit one relevant page
Website	Orient the visitor within the path	Begin free course or view live teaching
Email	Nurture through consistent useful teaching	Attend one live class
Live course	Create direct experience and relationship	Continue practising
Membership	Provide rhythm, sangha and sustained guidance	Participate consistently
Retreat	Deepen practice with honest preparation	Integrate through ongoing sangha

Conversion sequence

- 01 A complete Facebook teaching answers one real question.
- 02 The post links to the matching page - not automatically to membership.
- 03 The page offers the complete free course or a relevant live class.
- 04 A welcome email sets expectations and introduces the path once.
- 05 The student attends or watches one live teaching.
- 06 A follow-up explains how the membership supports continued practice.

How to communicate with this community

Voice

- Plain, warm and unhurried; specific about what happens and when.
- Teach before asking. Every promotional message should carry something useful.
- Use invitations rather than commands: Begin, join, read, meet, practise.
- Name suffering accurately without amplifying it.
- State prerequisites and limits early; do not hide them to improve conversion.
- Explain price through the infrastructure and community it sustains.
- Write for experienced practitioners on advanced pages; do not flatten every message for beginners.

Information standard

- Use exact dates and named time zones, with a converter link.
- State whether recordings are included and how long they remain available.
- Identify the level and prerequisites near the top.
- Use one registration link as the canonical source.
- If dāna, sliding scale or scholarship exists, give it equal visual weight with the price.
- Answer the likely question nearest the button: prior experience, recordings, cancellation or attendance.

Facebook content strategy

One teaching	Serve and earn attention	One precise point from a current class, complete enough to be useful
The path	Reduce confusion	Why students begin with foundations before advanced practice
Teacher in the room	Let people experience Michael	A contextualised 60-90 second clip approved by Claire
Weekly rhythm	Make membership tangible	What Tuesday teaching or Sacred Sunday actually feels like
Sangha voice	Show belonging	A permissioned student reflection with course and years of practice
Retreat and land	Document place and depth	A day at Pemako, preparation, or a milestone - never pressure
Practical clarity	Remove friction	Time-zone and recording explainer before a course begins

Suggested weekly pattern

- Monday: one teaching or practice reflection.
- Wednesday: short approved video excerpt with context.
- Friday: one clear note about what is happening, with exact details.
- Monthly: one permissioned sangha or retreat story.
- Launch periods: teach around the course theme for several weeks, then invite at the real opening date.

Timeline of identifiable activity

Date	Event	What it shows
12-14 Nov 2021	Infinite Bliss retreat: Union of the Illusory Body and Clear Light; Zoom and in-person	Hybrid delivery and advanced retreat promotion were already established.
Approx. 2022	Dzogchen Practices and Transmission announcement	Registration, donations, returning students, international time zones and recording demand.
9 Mar 2024	Rite of Passage: Our Three Year Retreat Concludes	Major lineage and institutional milestone; 345 reactions and 72 comments visible.
Thanksgiving, likely 2024	Happy Thanksgiving From All of Us at Pemako Retreat	Pemako presented as a living community identity; exact year should be verified.
Jul-Aug 2026	Regular teaching-led publishing	Recent sample receives 135-301 reactions and 15-33 comments.
Aug 2026	Website, course, membership and centre expansion	From client records: clearer Dzogchen path, Teachable development, video system and retreat-centre opening work.

Measurement and learning plan

Use measurement to improve clarity and service, not to coarsen the speech. Facebook Insights should be exported before setting targets.

Baseline metrics to obtain

- Follower count and 90-day net growth by the correct Facebook property.
- Reach and engagement rate by content pillar.
- Video 3-second views, 50% completion and full completion.
- Outbound clicks to free course, live course, schedule and membership.
- Comment themes: gratitude, question, access, registration, returning student, retreat interest.
- Email signups and live-class registrations attributed to Facebook UTMs.
- Membership conversions by prior relationship: cold, free course, past course, returning student, retreat.

Recommended events

Track free-course signup, newsletter signup, live-course registration click, recording-policy interaction, membership CTA click and completed checkout. Use a consistent convention such as `utm_source=facebook`, `utm_medium=social`, and a descriptive campaign name.

Decision rules

- High engagement but low clicks: the teaching resonates; the next step or link is unclear.
- Healthy signups but low live attendance: expectations, reminders, time zones or scheduling are weak.
- Good live attendance but low membership: the weekly rhythm or relevance of belonging is unclear.
- Membership clicks but failed checkout: payment architecture, price clarity or technical handoff is the issue.
- A conversion lift that requires harsher speech, hidden prerequisites or weaker free teaching is rejected.

30 / 60 / 90-day action plan

First 30 days	Confirm Facebook properties and Insights access; verify the 600,000 figure; request permission from five comment candidates; obtain three direct student reflections; publish one canonical schedule; confirm recordings, prerequisites, pricing and dāna policy; add UTM conventions.
Days 31-60	Publish the first permissioned sangha stories; begin the three-post weekly pattern; launch or repair the welcome email sequence; create one live-course bridge into membership; align Teachable handoff with the website identity.
Days 61-90	Review cohort behaviour from Facebook to live teaching; refine membership objections; build a returning-student segment; publish a Pemako development story; compare content pillars without compromising voice or prerequisites.

The single most useful next move

Invite a small number of known students to describe, in their own words, what changes when teachings become a weekly relationship rather than a collection of recordings. That answer is the honest centre of the membership page.

Appendix · permission request

Suggested message

Hello [Name],

Thank you for the kind comment you shared on Lama Michael's Facebook post.

We are gently updating the Vajragarbha website and would be grateful for permission to include your words in a small 'What students say' section.

Your original comment was:
'[COMMENT]'

Would you be comfortable with us publishing this, either exactly as written or in a shorter version that we send to you for approval first?

If so, could you also tell us how long you have studied or practised with Lama Michael, which course, teaching or retreat you participated in, and how you would like your name to appear?

There is no pressure at all. We will only publish it with your clear permission.

Warmly,
Vajragarbha

Source references

- Michael Gregory Facebook profile: facebook.com/michael.gregory.9212
- Vajragarbha legacy website: dzogchenteaching.com
- Teachable school: buddhist-and-dzogchen-teachings.teachable.com
- Current rework: dzogchenteaching.vercel.app
- Client reference folder: /Users/christophekaisin/Documents/Davita - Michael /
- Project Gmail reference: label:lama-michael

Prepared as an internal strategy document. Verify changing dates, prices, schedules, access policies and permissions before publication.